

Interview Transcription:

Interaction of Kallappa A Biradar (the owner of the Mallikarjun Logistic Service) with Siddarth.

Siddarth: Hello there, I am Siddarth S, the founder of team 003 from the Software Engineering Group project. So today I am here for the live interaction with the owner of the Mallikarjun Logistics Service, a local logistics business located in Shirashyad, a small rural village in Karnataka.

Siddarth: Hello sir, my name is Siddarth. I am from IIT Madras data science course. I am involved in a software engineering group project. For that, I need some information from your logistics business.

So first, can you give me a brief introduction about yourself and your background?

Owner (Kallappa Biradar): Sir, my name is Kallappa Biradar. I am 30 years old. I am a farmer by profession, and doing this as a side business. The main purpose of my business is to provide logistics service for people in nearby villages.

Siddarth: Sir, can you tell me about your logistics business? How does it work?

Owner: Sir, I have some 10-12 people working for me (10 labourers, 1 dispatcher and 1 warehouse manager). Our main business is to export and dispatch heavy goods like furniture during house shifting, grains, fertilizers for farmers, etc.

Siddarth: So your main business revolves around moving goods from place to place locally. Can you explain in what other scenarios does your business come into play?

Owner: If the farmers need to send their grain harvest to the APMC market, then I deliver these goods for them and connect them to the market and during the marriage season I do the moving of heavy goods.

Siddarth: Sir, can you tell me about your geographical location?

Owner: Sir, this is a small village called Shirashyad, where there is no access to bigger logistical services like VRL. Hence I got this idea to help the locals. If it was a bigger city, it would be easy, but this is a small village with no bigger logistic service. Hence I am the one who is doing this service to the surrounding villages.

Siddarth: Now, can you tell me about your per month sales? I mean, how many orders do you get per month?

Owner: Sir, depending on the season. 10 to 15 is the average. And sometimes it even varies, sometimes 5, 6, 7, 8. The highest orders are received during seasonal times, like during harvest or marriage season etc.

Siddarth: Now, how many vehicles do you need to deliver your goods, as in for the transportation?

Owner: We have 8-9 vehicles in total sir. We have 2 trax, 2 goods carriers, 2 Tata Ace. We also have 2 tractors and 4 trailers used behind the tractor as load carriers.

Siddarth: How do you manage the billing system and payment process?

Owner: Sir, right now we don't have any technology for billing sir. I do it manually, I create manual receipts for the customers and it is very stressful.

Siddarth: In your business, what are the major issues that you face?

Owner: The main problem is regarding payments. Some people give me full amount. Some people give me half amount. Some people give payment very late. So, I do have some issues in payment occasionally. I already have around 50,000 rupees as due payments from customers who are mainly farmers. Secondly, processing payments to our workers is a big headache. I have to manually calculate their payroll from messy paper timesheets and fuel receipts. Honestly, my fleet is growing, and I suspect some drivers are faking fuel bills, but I don't have a system to cross-check their GPS mileage to prove it.

Siddarth: Do you face any issues regarding the warehouse management?

Owner: Yes sir, since some customers are farmers, they have to deal with grains, pesticides and fertilisers, whereas on the other side we have people who deal with just heavy goods like furniture and construction materials. So there's a mix of goods we are dealing with which becomes a problem to store in the warehouse. So there is no correct systematic storage in the warehouse.

Siddarth: Do you face any issues with equipment loss?

Owner: Yes, constantly. We use these expensive equipment like returnable plastic crates for the vegetables and thick padded blankets for the furniture. Drivers are always in a hurry and forget to bring them back from the farms or customer houses and in another case while loading or unloading, some equipment like ropes and belts get lost or damaged. The belt which is used to load heavy goods gets cut or gets lost. We are bleeding money replacing them, and there is no way to track whether the dispatched equipment has been restored or not

Siddarth: Does any sort of problem arise when the customers are booking the vehicles for services?

Owner: Yes sir definitely, this problem happens often during house shifting or heavy goods moving. There is a mis-estimate of the vehicle size and number of labourers needed. Customers book smaller vehicles and fewer labourers to save money, which causes problems for us to resend a new vehicle and labourers to the spot to complete the service. Customers may book small goods vehicles and 2 labourers to save money instead of a big vehicle and 4 labourers, or sometimes the vice versa which is a waste of diesel, labour and time.

Siddarth: Do you face problems during peak season when you receive multiple orders at same time?

Owner: Yes, definitely. There is a huge demand clash. Since most of the people here are farmers, at times of harvesting all farmers reach out at once. It becomes difficult to manage since I am managing things alone. So during peak times, the demand surges and it's difficult to manage.

Siddarth: Do you face any problem regarding the routes used for transportation?

Owner: Yes sir, another major problem is the long and unoptimised routes sir. Vehicles may have to run for just a single order way long, because of the confusing interior and local routes which is a waste of fuel, labour and time.

Siddarth: Do you face any problems regarding communication with the workers and customers during the time of the delivery?

Owner: Yes sir, there is a major problem regarding the communication bridge. There is no proper communication bridge between customers and drivers and myself. I am the only bridge between the drivers and customers and sometimes customers are unreachable. If there is any delay in the delivery, then there is chaos. There is no such mechanism to track the driver and the delivery. Since this is a rural area, there are frequent network related issues.

Siddarth: Thank you sir, it was great meeting you. I have received lots of insights from you and we are looking to create a software solution on this. I hope this helps.

Summary:

Siddarth interviews Kallappa A. Biradar, the owner of Mallikarjun Logistic Service, a small rural logistics business based in Shirashyad, Karnataka. Kallappa is primarily a farmer and runs the logistics business as a side venture to serve nearby villages where larger logistics companies are unavailable.

The business employs around 10–12 staff members, including laborers, a dispatcher, and a warehouse manager. It handles transportation of furniture during house shifting, agricultural goods such as grains and fertilizers, construction materials, and seasonal deliveries like harvest transport to APMC markets and marriage-related shifting services. Orders vary seasonally, averaging 10–15 per month, with higher demand during harvest and wedding seasons. The fleet consists of multiple vehicles including goods carriers, Tata Ace vehicles, tractors, trailers, and trax vehicles.

However, the business faces several operational challenges:

- **Manual Billing & Payment Issues:** All billing is done manually. Payments are inconsistent, delayed, or partial. Payroll calculation is stressful due to paper-based records, and there is suspicion of fuel bill manipulation without a system to verify.
- **Warehouse Management Problems:** Mixed storage of agricultural goods (grains, fertilizers, pesticides) and heavy goods (furniture, construction materials) leads to unorganized storage and inefficiency.
- **Equipment Loss:** Returnable crates, padded blankets, ropes, and belts are frequently lost or damaged, with no tracking mechanism to monitor issued and returned equipment.
- **Booking Mis-estimation:** Customers often underestimate or overestimate vehicle size and labor requirements to save costs, leading to service delays, resource wastage, and operational inefficiencies.
- **Peak Season Demand Clash:** During harvest seasons, multiple farmers place orders simultaneously, making it difficult to manage operations alone.
- **Unoptimized Routes:** Poor interior road conditions and lack of route planning cause long travel distances, fuel wastage, and time loss.
- **Communication Gaps:** There is no proper communication system between drivers and customers. Delivery delays create chaos, and there is no real-time tracking system compounded by rural network issues.